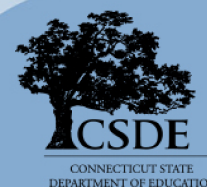


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



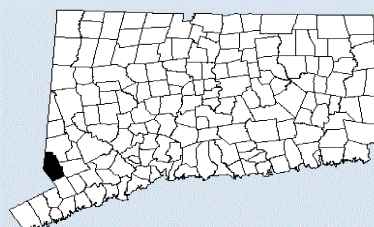
Ridgefield School District

Dr. Susie Dasilva, Superintendent • 203-894-5550 • <http://www.ridgefield.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	18
Enrollment	4,556
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$21,019
Total Expenditures ¹	\$99,210,758

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	2,332	51.2	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	316	6.9	5.2
Black or African American	30	0.7	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	380	8.3	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	180	4.0	4.0
White	3,642	79.9	49.9
English Learners	50	1.1	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	246	5.4	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	668	14.7	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	69	3.1	6	0.3
Male	70	3.0	23	1.0
Black or African American	*	*	0	0.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	18	4.6	*	*
White	109	3.0	25	0.7
English Learners	*	*	0	0.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	26	9.3	*	*
Students with Disabilities	76	10.9	14	1.7
District	139	3.1	29	0.6
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 0

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Ridgefield School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	315.9
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	3.1
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	52.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	86.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	8.0
School Level	25.2
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	9.0
Support Staff	4.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	18.1
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	34.6
School Nurses	11.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	228.5

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	5	1.1	1.3
Black or African American	2	0.4	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	9	1.9	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	1	0.2	0.1
Two or More Races	1	0.2	0.1
White	445	95.9	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	6.0	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	18	75.0	31	83.8
White	258	78.7	327	92.1
English Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	6	*	*	*
Students with Disabilities	35	68.6	43	69.4
District	310	79.3	396	91.9
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	52	57.1
Emotional Disturbance	50	69.4
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	213	88.4
Other Health Impairment	126	88.1
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	43	97.7
District	492	79.9
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Ridgefield School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	96	2.1	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	72	1.6	1.1
Intellectual Disability	12	0.3	0.5
Learning Disability	242	5.4	5.8
Other Health Impairment	143	3.2	3.3
Other Disabilities	25	0.6	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	64	1.4	1.9
All Disabilities	654	14.5	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	13	2.0	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	35	5.4	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$60,647,840	\$12,849	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$6,988,776	\$1,493	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$6,311,421	\$1,349	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$1,390,887	\$297	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$6,453,473	\$1,379	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$1,856,840	\$397	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$9,976,424	\$2,132	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$4,383,726	\$932	\$1,159
Food services	.	.	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$1,201,372	\$257	\$151
Total	\$99,210,758	\$21,019	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$6,443,827	34.0	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,281,847	12.0	11.1
Other Salaries	\$1,557,165	8.2	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$2,866,748	15.1	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,163,964	6.1	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$3,292,768	17.4	22.5
Supplies	\$48,607	0.3	0.5
Property Services	\$4,825	0.0	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,293,097	6.8	7.2
Equipment	\$22,220	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$18,975,068	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		19.1	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	96.6
State	2.3
Federal	1.1
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Ridgefield School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
READING	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Ridgefield School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	33	90.9
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	12	*
Students with Disabilities	49	83.7
District	393	97.5
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	96.2	321	76.4
Male	*	*	*
Black or African American	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	88.5	35	57.4
White	95.3	494	72.3
English Learners	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	12	*
Students with Disabilities	74.3	19	16.8
District	95.0	597	72.6
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	91.7	98.3
Male	81.7	94.0
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	87.1	*
White	86.6	96.2
English Learners	N/A	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	79.1	86.0
District	86.7	96.1
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Ridgefield School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	3.1%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	9.6%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	85.9%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	72.6%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		97.5%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		97.5%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		91.0%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		86.7%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		42.4%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	91.0%	3.0%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Ridgefield School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Ridgefield Public Schools is always seeking to grow ever better in systems, structures, professional learning, engagement and communication with families. Creating a student centered, equitable experience for all students continues to be the driving force as the district seeks to educate students to achieve the skills of the RPS Vision of the Graduate.

This drive is evident in the organizational structures and the communication and collaboration between Central Office and the schools. New administrative curriculum positions added this year supported the collection of current curriculum materials, which then led departments to collaboratively revise, memorialize and align their curriculum and curriculum resources. This memorialization and alignment supports all students, but especially supports special educators as they modify curriculum to best support the needs of their learners.

In addition, these curriculum administrator positions provide leadership support, a line of clear communication and greater understanding of student and teacher needs. This communication has led to professional learning plans that best meet the needs of the departments and the students they support. For example, in the Fall of '21, the general education and special education teachers will engage in the study of a phonemic awareness curriculum resource that will be implemented in all schools PK to first grade and in intervention and special education programs. This work is in addition to the professional learning that the special education department engaged in during the 20-21 school year in DBT, OG and Wilson Reading.

During the 20-21 school year, RPS made additional efforts to connect with students that were not logging in for classes, or were in other ways, not available for learning. In addition to all of the meetings and conversations with families, RPS offered ongoing responsive mental health support. Plans were created as needed.

RPS schools at all levels used a variety of strategies to continue to work on social emotional support and build the bridge from home to the school community. The goal was to connect back with students that may have felt disconnected and to continue to focus on community engagement. The strategies included virtual trivia nights or other similar fun activities that bring families and staff together.

This year communication to families was especially important. RPS continued to provide and update a teacher and parent-facing website, send regular newsletters, and place positive phone calls home. The Superintendent sent out weekly updates and all buildings followed the 24-hour response guideline to connect back with family questions or concerns. Across the year, RPS used a variety of different surveys to gauge parent feedback on a range of different topics from health and safety to feedback on the free summer SEL program for students in grades PK through 12. Finally, the use of google classroom, youtube, and google meet allowed a greater number of parents easy access to workshops, PTA meetings, and events, and offered a view into their child's learning life.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Ridgefield Public Schools continues to work to reduce isolation, racial, ethnic, economic, or any other type, as the District seeks to bring the mission and vision of the graduate to life for all students progressing through the district. This is evident in different ways across the levels.

Students at the elementary level experience classroom libraries that include windows into other cultures and perspectives, as well as mirrors into students' own lives. In addition, many texts that students encounter include positive messages about culture, tolerance, empathy, and kindness. The ever-growing collections reinforce the inclusion and value of all students in RPS. Both the elementary and middle schools continued to rely on past professional development and partnership with RULER. Social emotional learning committees and curriculum writing teams created resources and strategies for teachers to use with their students.

At the middle school level students engage in learning about different perspectives. This was done in a variety of ways through book choice, workshops and curriculum. One example of this was the presentation by a Holocaust survivor. Additionally, student learning focused on curiosity, critical thinking, and questioning, especially in Social Studies and Science instruction that engages in the inquiry cycle. The student-centered and inquiry-based approach helped foster empathy and informed citizenship.

At the high school, various activities are implemented that collectively qualify the school to obtain the Anti-Defamation League's No Place for Hate (NPFH) designation. This past year school-wide activities focused on Asian American and Pacific Islander Heritage month. We held an interactive assembly program that focused on: understanding bias and prejudice and how to be an ally. Students learned about a social media campaign that shared stories of students living the NPFH pledge and a school-wide collection of intentional acts of respect.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Ridgefield School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

RPS strives to create a student centered, equitable experience for all students. This includes the equitable allocation of resources. At each of the levels, systems have been established to ensure this. Central leaders supports the schools in this work by evaluating and revising curriculum and the MTSS process with teachers and administrators. Consistent class size guidelines, aligned collaborative professional learning across levels and a push to memorialize curriculum is also done. Initiatives are identified through needs assessments and the curriculum review processes. These studies are clearly communicated and teachers are then supported at the classroom level to ensure consistency and calibration. Hiring is a collaborative process. This district wide approach results in high quality candidates for all schools. At the funding level, RPS continues to use partial resource allocation based upon student enrollment, which provides equity in terms of student funding. Limited Title I and Title II funds are used to supplement the schools, based on a needs assessment and eligibility.